☕ JAVA FOR SDETs · #1

@qaafterhours

my interview-prep notes

4 Java variables every SDET gets asked about

Instance

Static

Local

Parameter

QA by day, learning after hours

swipe →

FIRST, THE BASICS

A variable is a named box that holds a value.

```
int     retryCount = 3;
String  browser    = "Chrome";
boolean testPassed = true;
```

The interview question is about **where** you declare it. That decides the type:

Instance • **Static** • **Local** • **Parameter**

① INSTANCE VARIABLE

Every object gets its own copy.

```
class TestConfig {
    String browser;  // instance
}

test1.browser = "Chrome";
test2.browser = "Firefox";
// same field, different values
```

Where: inside the class, outside methods
Belongs to: the object

② STATIC VARIABLE

One copy, shared by everyone.

```
class FrameworkConfig {
    static final int DEFAULT_TIMEOUT = 30;
}

// every test reads the same value
FrameworkConfig.DEFAULT_TIMEOUT
```

Where: inside the class, with static
Belongs to: the class, not objects

③ LOCAL VARIABLE

Lives and dies inside the method.

```
public void verifyLogin() {
    String expectedTitle = "Dashboard";
    int retryCount = 2;
}
// can't use retryCount out here ❌
```

⚠️ **Interview trap: local variables get NO default value. Use one before assigning it and it won't compile.**

④ PARAMETER

The input you pass into a method.

```
public void verifyProduct(String productName) {
    search(productName);
}

verifyProduct("Air Fryer");
```

Where: in the method/constructor brackets
It's a variable, but not a field

ALL 4 IN ONE TEST CLASS

Screenshot this one 📸

```
public class LoginTest {

  String browser = "Chrome";
  static final int DEFAULT_TIMEOUT = 30;

  public void login(String username) {
    String expectedTitle = "Dashboard";
  }
}
```

- **browser → Instance**
- **DEFAULT_TIMEOUT → Static**
- **username → Parameter**
- **expectedTitle → Local**

☕ Java for SDETs #1

Save this for your next interview 📌

Quick quiz before #2 👇

Which of these 4 gets NO default value?

Drop your answer in the comments.

Next up: Default values, the rule that trips people up

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